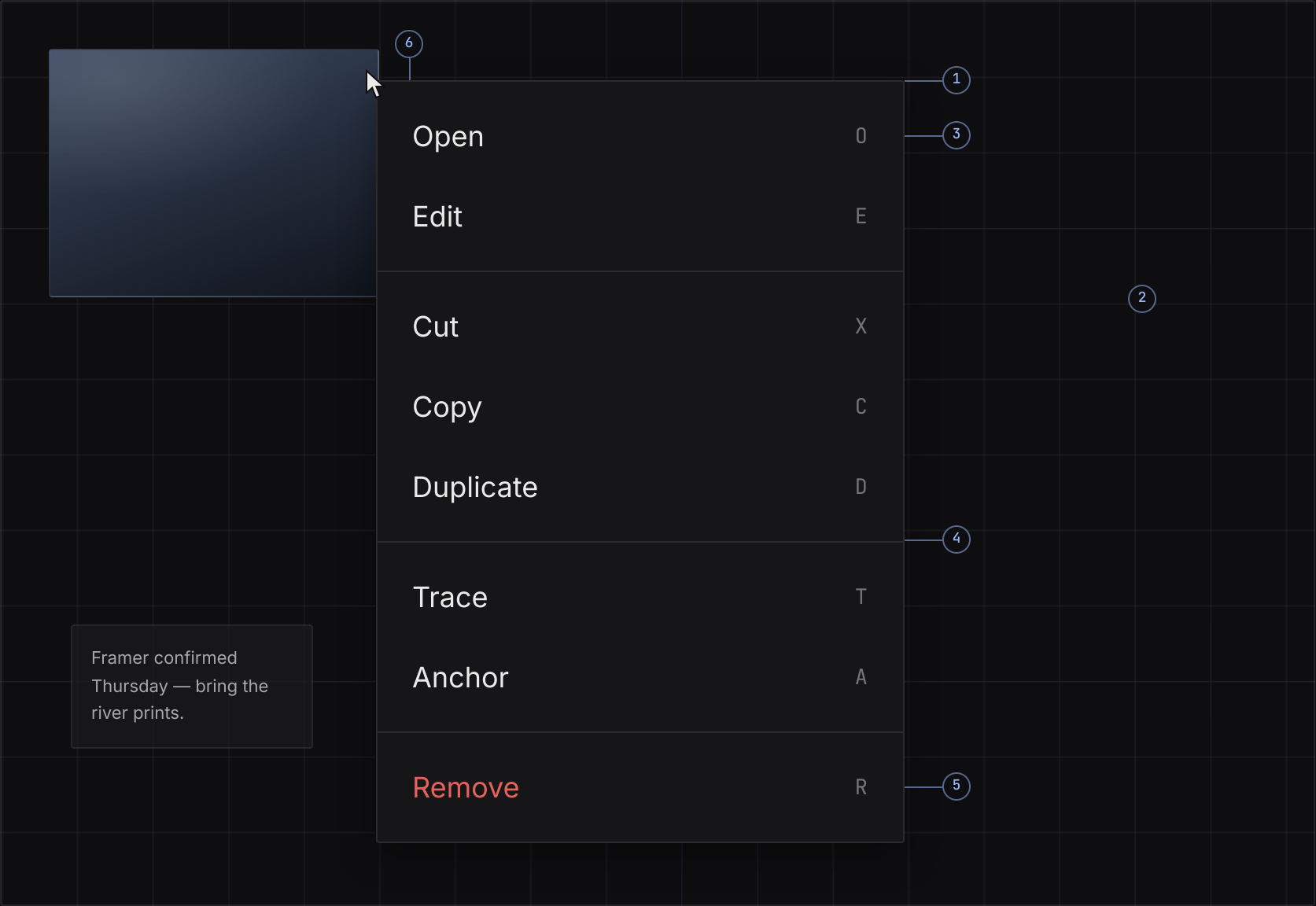


EVERY PLANE · NEUTRAL CHROME

# MENUS

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ROW ANATOMY · THREE TARGETS · SURFACE ACTIONS · FLYOUT · KEYBOARD  
GRAMMAR · REFUSALS



- 01

**SURFACE FILL, 2PX RADIUS**

Fill #161618 on a quiet 1px border. 2px is the only radius Grove chrome owns; a rounded menu is a foreign object.
- 02

**NO SCRIM**

The workspace behind stays fully lit and live. Nothing dims to make a menu matter — it is chrome, not an event.
- 03

**LABEL LEFT, KEY RIGHT**

A plain verb in UI type, one unmodified stroke in mono at reduced ink. Rows never wrap and never truncate.
- 04

**HAIRLINE GROUPS**

A 1px separator bounds each intent group: open and edit, clipboard, context, removal. Grouping is the only hierarchy a menu gets.
- 05

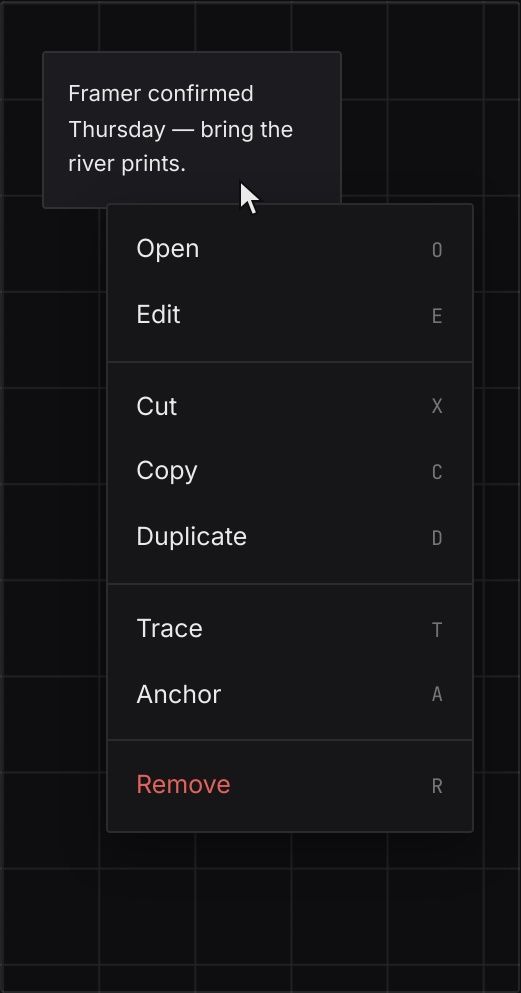
**DESTRUCTIVE STANDS ALONE**

Remove reads in the invalid role, in its own group, never beside the default row — a fast hand cannot land on it by habit.
- 06

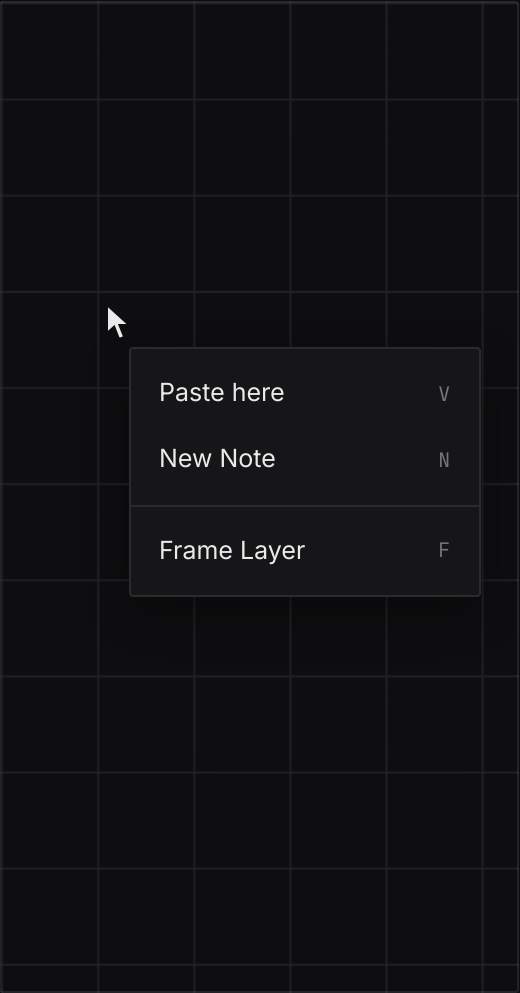
**NO TITLE**

A menu names nothing, not even itself. The thing that was clicked is the title.

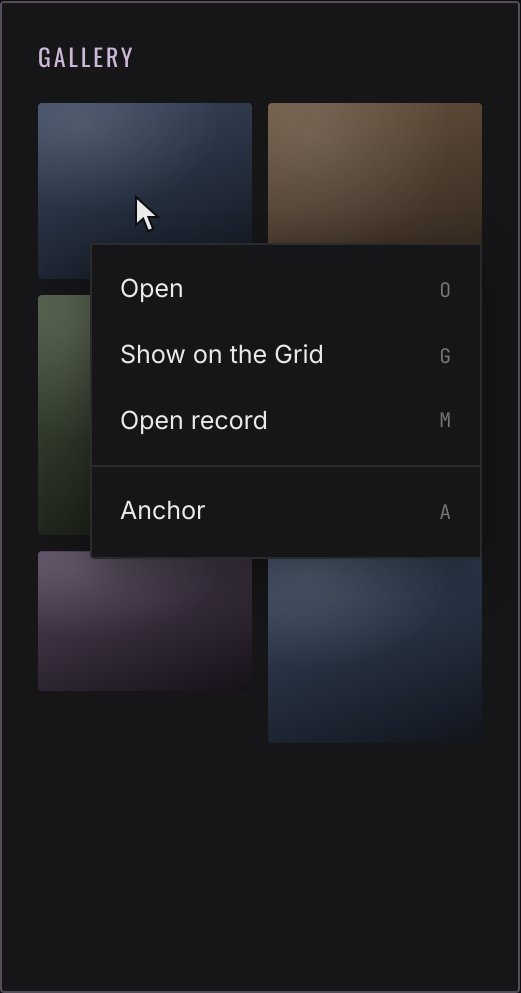
CM-01 · ON CONTENT



CM-02 · ON SPACE



CM-04 · IN A SURFACE



- 01

ONE GRAMMAR, THREE TARGETS

Content, empty space, and the inside of a surface all get the same cloth: same fill, same rows, same keys. Only the actions change.
- 02

A SHORT LIST PER TARGET

Each target answers with the actions it supports and no others – open, edit, clipboard, duplicate, remove where they apply, plus what only that target can do.
- 03

OMITTED, NEVER GRAYED

An action that does not apply is absent. A disabled gray row is an apology for a wrong list; Grove does not print apologies.
- 04

NO ACTIONS, NO MENU

A target with nothing to offer shows nothing at all. An empty menu – or a menu of one filler row – never opens.

LOCAL EDITOR · A NOTE

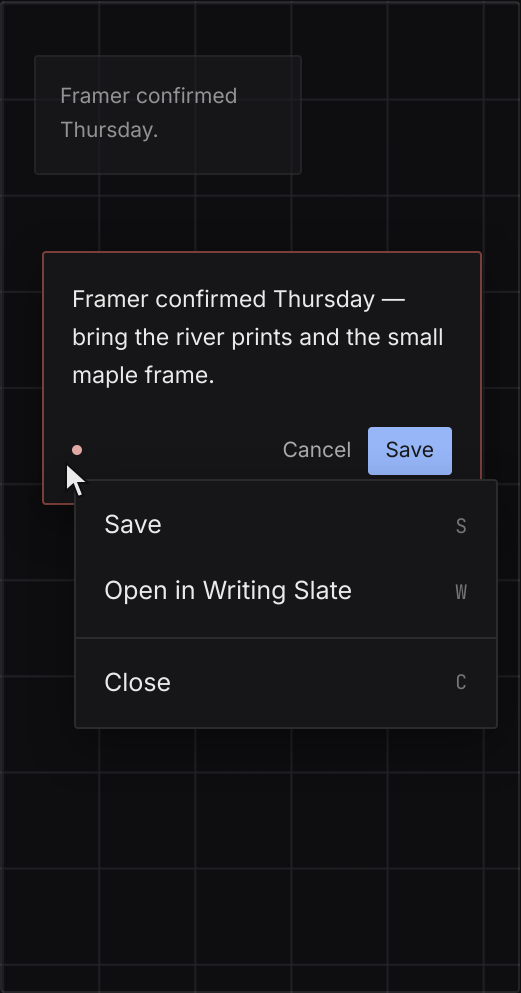
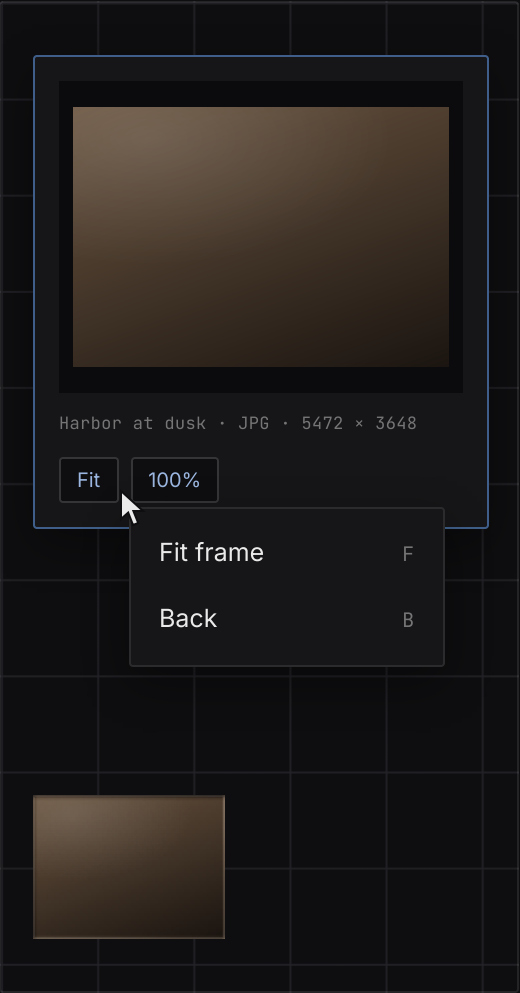
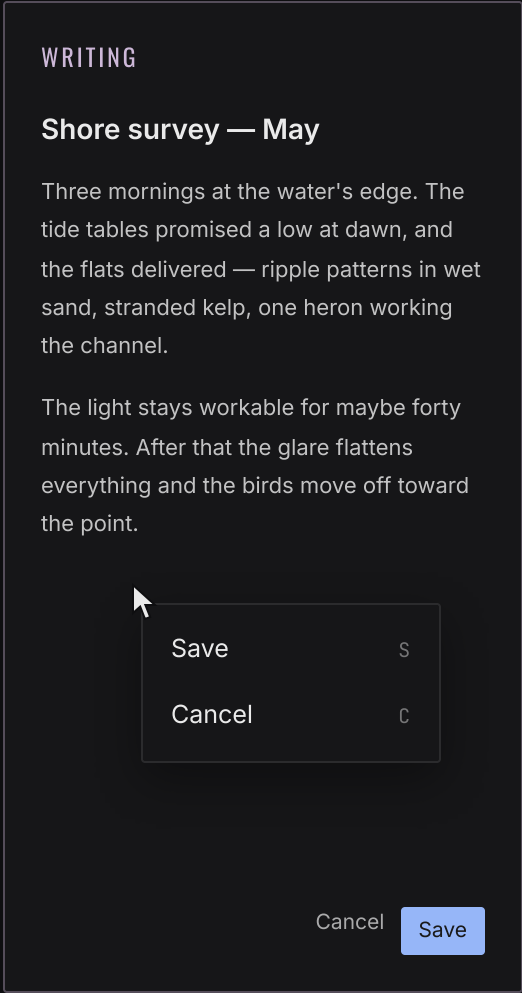


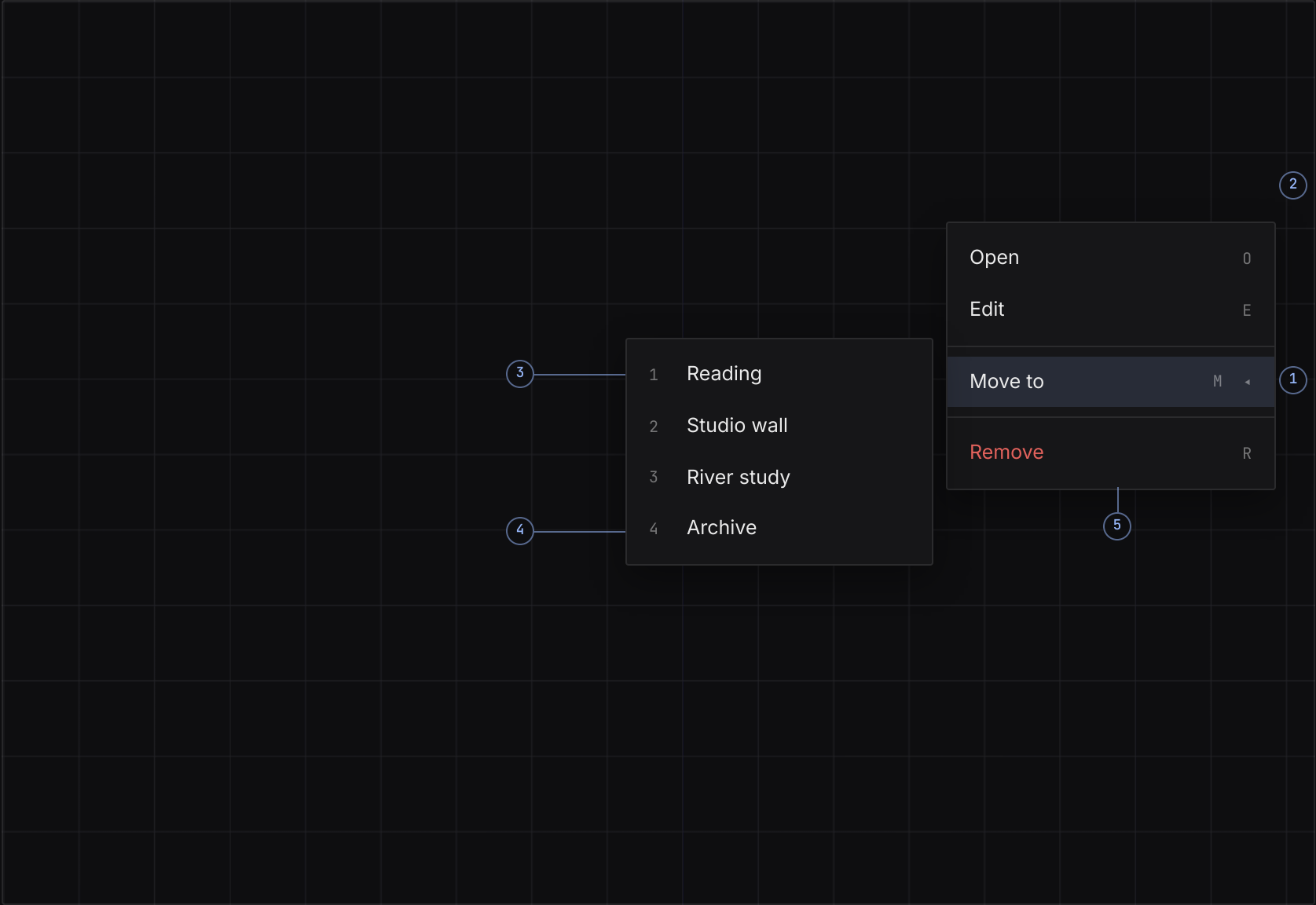
IMAGE VIEWER · A PHOTOGRAPH



WRITING SLATE · A DOCUMENT



- 01 THE SURFACE ANSWERS**  
Every surface supplies its own short list of what it can do. There is no single global menu carrying rows that do not apply here.
- 02 BORROWED VOCABULARY**  
A text editor answers like a plain text editor; a viewer answers like a photo viewer. The words people already own are the right words.
- 03 TWO ROWS IS A WHOLE MENU**  
A short list is a correct list. Length is never padded to look substantial, and a row never appears just to fill a group.
- 04 SAME CLOTH, DIFFERENT WORDS**  
Fill, border, radius, label left and key right do not change from one surface to the next. Only the actions do.
- 05 OPENING CHANGES NOTHING**  
The menu asks the surface what it offers and draws it. No draft is saved, no view moves, no state is touched until a row is chosen.



- 01 PARENT ROW HELD**

Move to stays highlighted the whole time its flyout is open. The eye can always trace the child back to the row that owns it.
- 02 FLIPPED AT THE EDGE**

Near the right edge the flyout opens leftward, and the row's arrow points the way. The whole menu is always on screen – never clipped, never scrolled.
- 03 DIGITS PICK DESTINATIONS**

Destinations are numbered 1-n in mono. One keystroke moves the content; the digit is the quick key, so no row carries a second one.
- 04 ONE LEVEL, EVER**

A flyout never opens a flyout. A list too deep for one level is navigation, and navigation is not a menu's job.
- 05 LEFT-ARROW RETREATS ONE STEP**

← closes only the flyout and returns to the held row. Escape still closes the topmost surface – here, that same flyout first.

|           |   |
|-----------|---|
| Open      | O |
| Edit      | E |
| Cut       | X |
| Copy      | C |
| Duplicate | D |
| Trace     | T |
| Anchor    | A |
| Remove    | R |

T

↑

↓

ENTER

ESC

- 01

SINGLE STROKES, PRINTED

Every row shows its key – one unmodified stroke, no chords to memorize. T fires Trace the instant it is pressed.
- 02

LIVE ONLY WHILE OPEN

Quick keys belong to the menu, not the workspace. Closed, T types a letter again; nothing is globally reserved.
- 03

HOVER AND ARROWS AGREE

↕ walk the rows, Enter fires the lit one. Pointer and keyboard light the identical row state – one highlight, two hands.
- 04

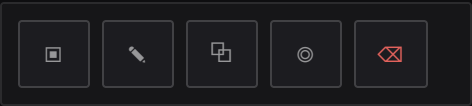
ESCAPE PEELS ONE LAYER

Escape closes the topmost surface and only that surface – flyout before menu, menu before nothing.
- 05

STABLE ORDER

Within a target kind the rows never reshuffle – the HIG rule that muscle memory is part of the contract. Position is learned once.

✕ ICON STRIP AS MENU



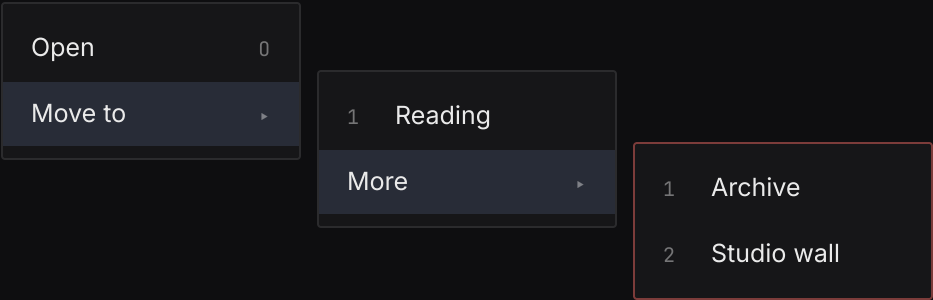
A ROW IS A LABELED WORD. AN ICON STRIP MAKES THE READER DECODE PICTURES BEFORE ACTING – AND HIDES THE QUICK KEY.

✕ REMOVE BESIDE THE DEFAULT ROW

|        |   |
|--------|---|
| Open   | O |
| Remove | R |
| Edit   | E |

A FAST HAND AIMS AT OPEN BY HABIT. THE DESTRUCTIVE ROW SITS IN ITS OWN GROUP AT THE END, BEHIND A HAIRLINE – NEVER ONE SLIP AWAY.

✕ FLYOUT INSIDE A FLYOUT



ONE FLYOUT LEVEL EVER. A SECOND CASCADE IS NAVIGATION WEARING MENU CLOTH – THE DIGITS CAN NO LONGER SAY WHICH LIST THEY PICK FROM.

✕ A TITLE NAMING MACHINERY

|                          |   |
|--------------------------|---|
| SESSION · EDITOR ACTIONS |   |
| Open                     | O |
| Edit                     | E |

A MENU NEEDS NO TITLE – THE THING CLICKED IS THE TITLE. AND MACHINERY NOUNS NEVER REACH THE SCREEN; ONE IS ENOUGH TO FAIL REVIEW.